Tzu-Heng (Brian) Huang

thuang273@wisc.edu zihengh1.github.io zihengh1 zihengh1

Education

2021 – Aug. 2026 (Expected) **Ph.D. in Computer Science. University of Wisconsin-Madison.**
Advised by Frederic Sala.

2016 – 2020 **B.S. in Computer Science. National Chengchi University.**
Advised by Man-Kwan Shan and Ling-Jyh Chen. Major GPA: *3.96/4.00.*

Research Summary

My research focuses on ***data-centric AI for multimodal models***, with the goal of enabling systems to learn more from less but higher-quality supervision. Several ***data lifecycle*** projects I have worked on, including **(i)** *rubric-guided RL* for visual pretraining, **(ii)** data selection using *weight-space geometry* for efficient pretraining ***(ICML'26 + ICML'25 DataWorld Oral)***, **(iii)** *online data mixing* for overhead-reduced multimodal training, **(iv)** *data curation* via ensemble and objective detection ***(1st place on the DataComp'23 leaderboard)***, and **(v)** a 500x cheaper *automated data labeling* system as an alternative to LLM annotators (***NeurIPS'24 Spotlight***).

Research Experience

Oct. 2025 – Jan. 2026 **AIML Research Intern. Apple Inc.**
advised by Manjot Bilkhu and Javier Movellan.
— *Rubric-based RL for Dense Captioning Tasks.*

May. 2025 – Sep. 2025 **Research Scientist Intern. Meta GenAI (now MSL).**
advised by Ernie Chang, Sang Michael Xie, Yiting Lu, and David Kant.
— *Learnability-aware Synthetic Data Generation.*

May. 2024 – Dec. 2024 **AIML Research Intern. Apple Inc.**
advised by Javier Movellan and Manjot Bilkhu.
— *Automated Model-aware Data Selection for Efficient Pretraining.*
— *Optimizing Domain Mixtures for MLLM Pretraining.*

Aug. 2021 – Present **Graduate Research Student. UW-Madison.**
advised by Frederic Sala.
— *Data-centric AI for Foundation Models: Auto-labeling and Data Curation.*
— *Parameter Marketplace: Through Model Merging and Auction Agents.*

May. 2023 – May. 2024 **Founder. Awan.AI LLC.**
— *Tongue Syndrome Diagnosis and LLM for Traditional Chinese Medicine.*
— *Automating TCM Diagnosis: Herbal-based Recommendation System.*

Jun. 2019 – Sep. 2019 **Research Intern. Argonne National Laboratory.**
advised by Charlie Catlett and Rajesh Sankaran.
— *Ensemble-based Time Series Calibration for Low-cost Sensors.*

Sep. 2018 – Aug. 2021 **Research Assistant. National Chengchi University.**
advised by Man-Kwan Shan.
— *Spatio-temporal Modeling in Large-scale Sensor Networks.*

Feb. 2018 – Jul. 2020 **Research Intern. Academia Sinica.**
advised by Ling-Jyh Chen.
— *Large-scale Air Quality Sensor Networks (AirBox).*

Publications and Preprints

1. **T.-H. Huang**, S. Qiu, and F. Sala, "Time to Impeach LLM-as-a-Judge: Programs are the Future of Evaluation," Under Review, 2026.

2. **T.-H. Huang**, A. Goyal, J. Cooper, and F. Sala, "WARP: Weight-Space Analysis for Recovering Training Data Portfolios," Under Review, 2026.

3. N. Roberts, S. Cho, Z. Gao, **T.-H. Huang**, A. Wu, G. Orlanski, A. Trost, K. Buchanan, A. Albarghouthi, and F. Sala, "Test-Time Scaling Makes Overtraining Compute-Optimal," Under Review, 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2604.01411

4. **T.-H. Huang**, S. Salekin, J. Movellan, F. Sala, and M. Bilkhu, "RubiCap: Rubric-Guided Reinforcement Learning for Dense Image Captioning," Under Review, 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.09160

5. J. Zhao, C. Shin, **T.-H. Huang**, S. S. S. Namburi, and F. Sala, "CARE: Confounder-Aware Aggregation for Reliable LLM Evaluation," in *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2026. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.00039

6. J. Saad-Falcon, E. K. Buchanan, M. F. Chen, **T.-H. Huang**, B. McLaughlin, T. Bhathal, S. Zhu, B. Athiwaratkun, F. Sala, S. Linderman, A. Mirhoseini, and C. Re, "Shrinking the Generation-Verification Gap by Scaling Compute for Verification," in *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), ICML Workshop: Efficient Systems for Foundation Models (ES-FoMo III), and ICML Workshop: Multi-Agent Systems in the Era of Foundation Models: Opportunities, Challenges and Futures (MAS)*, 2025. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.18203

7. **T.-H. Huang**, H. Vishwakarma, and F. Sala, "Time to Impeach LLM-as-a-Judge: Programs are the Future of Evaluation," in *ICML Workshop: Programmatic Representations for Agent Learning (PRAL)*, 2025. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.10403

8. J. Zhao, C. Shin, **T.-H. Huang**, S. S. S. Namburi, and F. Sala, "From Many Voices to One: A Statistically Principled Aggregation of LLM Judges," in *NeurIPS Workshop: Evaluating the Evolving LLM Lifecycle: Benchmarks, Emergent Abilities, and Scaling, and NeurIPS Workshop: Reliable ML from Unreliable Data*, 2025. URL: https://openreview.net/pdf?id=0u53DNvjx7

9. A. Ge, **T.-H. Huang**, J. Cooper, A. Trost, Z. Chu, S. S. S. Namburi, Z. Cai, K. Park, N. Roberts, and F. Sala, "R&B: Domain Regrouping and Data Mixture Balancing for Efficient Foundation Model Training," in *ICML Workshop: Unifying Data Curation Frameworks Across Domains (DataWorld), and ICML Workshop: Data in Generative Models (The Bad, the Ugly, and the Greats) (DIG-BUGS)*, 2025. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.00358

10. **T.-H. Huang**, M. Bilkhu, J. Cooper, F. Sala, and J. Movellan, "Evaluating Sample Utility for Efficient Data Selection by Mimicking Model Weights," in *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), and ICML Workshop: Unifying Data Curation Frameworks Across Domains (DataWorld)* ***[Oral Paper]***, 2025. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2501.06708

11. **T.-H. Huang**, C. Cao, V. Bhargava, and F. Sala, "The ALCHEmist: Automated Labeling 500x CHEaper than LLM Data Annotators," in *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)* ***[Spotlight Paper (Top 2.08%)]***, 2024. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2407.11004

12. W. Tan, N. Roberts, **T.-H. Huang**, J. Zhao, J. Cooper, S. Guo, C. Duan, and F. Sala, "MoRe Fine-Tuning with 10x Fewer Parameters," in *ICML Workshop: Efficient Systems for Foundation Models (ES-FoMo), and ICML Workshop: Foundation Models in the Wild.*, 2024. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2408.17383

13. N. Roberts, X. Li, D. Adila, S. Cromp, **T.-H. Huang**, J. Zhao, and F. Sala, "Geometry-Aware Adaptation for Pretrained Models," in *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2023. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2307.12226

14. **T.-H. Huang**, H. Vishwakarma, and F. Sala, "Train 'n Trade: Foundations of Parameter Markets," in *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2023. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2312.04740

15 **T.-H. Huang**, C. Shin, S. J. Tay, D. Adila, and F. Sala, "Multimodal Data Curation via Object Detection and Filter Ensembles," in *ICCV Workshop: Towards the Next Generation of Computer Vision Datasets (TNGCV)* ***[1st place on the Datacomp leaderboard (small-scale filtering track)]***, 2023. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2401.12225

16 **T.-H. Huang**, C. Cao, S. Schoenberg, H. Vishwakarma, N. Roberts, and F. Sala, "ScriptoriumWS: A Code Generation Assistant for Weak Supervision," in *ICLR Workshop: Deep Learning For Code (DL4C)*, 2023. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2502.12366

17 N. Roberts, X. Li, **T.-H. Huang**, D. Adila, S. Schoenberg, C.-Y. Liu, L. Pick, H. Ma, A. Albarghouthi, and F. Sala, "AutoWS-Bench-101: Benchmarking Automated Weak Supervision with 100 Labels," in *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2022. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2208.14362

18 **T.-H. Huang**, C.-H. Tsai, and M.-K. Shan, "Key Sensor Discovery for Quality Audit of Air Sensor Networks," in *ACM International Conference on Mobile Systems, Applications, and Services (MobiSys)*, 2020. URL: https://dl.acm.org/doi/abs/10.1145/3386901.3396606

Miscellaneous

Awards

2026 **Gold Reviewer Award**, recognized by ICML'26.

2025 **Oral Paper: Grad-Mimic (Over 100+ submissions)**, selected by ICML'25 DataWorld.

2024 **Spotlight Paper (Top 2.08%): The Alchemist**, selected by NeurIPS'24.

2023 **ICCV Datacomp Competition**, won the first place in the small-scale filtering track.

Scholar Award, granted by NeurIPS'23.

2021 **First-year Departmental Scholarship**, granted by UW-Madison.

2020 **Research Intern Scholarship**, granted by National Chengchi University.

Undergrad Research Scholarship, granted by Ministry of Science and Technology.

Invited Talks

Jan. 2026 **Data Recipes: Labeling, Selection, and Verification**, invited by National Tsing Hua University (NTHU).

Data Recipes: Labeling, Selection, and Verification, invited by National Taiwan University (NTU).

Data Recipes: Labeling, Selection, and Verification, invited by Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (TSMC).

Data Recipes: Labeling, Selection, and Verification, invited by National Yang Ming Chiao Tung University (NYCU).

Aug. 2025 **Data Recipes: Automated Labeling and Efficient Selection**, invited by Scaling Intelligence Lab (Azalia Mirhoseini's group) in Stanford University.

Apr. 2025 **Spatio-temporal Modeling for Underwater Sensor Networks**, invited by National Taipei University of Technology (NTUT).

Dec. 2019 **Air Quality Sensor Network Developments**, invited by Nangang High School (Taiwan).

Sep. 2019 **Internship Research Talk**, invited by National Chengchi Univerisity.

Jul. 2019 **LASS Conference: International Session**, invited by Academia Sinica.

Mar. 2019 **Techbang Magazine: PiM25 Project**, invited by Techbang Magazine.

Raspberry Pi Jam: PiM25 Project, invited by Raspberry Pi Foundation (Taiwan).

Jan. 2019 **Raspberry Pi Meetup: PiM25 Project**, invited by Raspberry Pi Foundation (Taiwan).

Miscellaneous (continued)

Academic Services

2026 – Present — **Organizer**, Data Foundations of AI (**new data-first online seminars**).

2021 – Present — **Active Paper Reviewer**, NeurIPS, ICLR, and ICML.

2023 — **Co-organizer**, AutoML Cup in AutoML Conference.

2022 – 2023 — **President of Student Association of Taiwan**, UW-Madison.

2021 – 2022 — **Vice President of Student Association of Taiwan**, UW-Madison.

Consulting Roles

2025 — **Research Consultant**, Water Resources Agency, Ministry of Economic Affairs in Taiwan. Focusing on underwater sensor network developments and flood detection modeling.

2023 – 2025 — **Research Consultant**, TechTCM. Focusing on AI for Traditional Chinese Medicine.

Skills

Programming Languages — Python, R, C++/C, SQL, LaTeX, and Shell Programming.

Technologies — (Distributed) PyTorch, Tensorflow, Keras, PostgreSQL, and Vim.